3 Using virtual machines: EC2

This chapter covers

- Launching a virtual machine with Linux
- Controlling a virtual machine remotely via the Session Manager
- Monitoring and debugging a virtual machine
- Saving costs for virtual machines

It's impressive what you can achieve with the computing power of the smartphone in your pocket or the laptop in your bag. But if your task requires massive computing power or high network traffic, or needs to run reliably 24/7, a virtual machine is a better fit. With a virtual machine, you get access to a slice of a physical machine located in a data center. On AWS, virtual machines are offered by the service called Elastic Compute Cloud (EC2).

Not all examples are covered by Free Tier

The examples in this chapter are not all covered by the Free Tier. A special warning message appears when an example incurs costs. As for the other examples, as long as you don't run them longer than a few days, you won't pay anything for them. Keep in mind that this applies only if you created a fresh AWS account for this book and nothing else is going on in your AWS account. Try to complete the chapter within a few days; you'll clean up your account at the end.

In this chapter, you will learn how to launch and manage a virtual machine on AWS. Also, we will show you how to connect to a virtual machine to install or configure applications. On top of that, you will learn how to monitor a virtual machine. Last but not least, we will introduce the different